

Ideation Phase: Streamlining Ticket Assignment for Efficient Support Operations

1. Objective of the Ideation Phase

To generate, explore, and evaluate innovative solutions for improving how support tickets are assigned — aiming to reduce response times, balance workloads, and enhance customer satisfaction through intelligent automation and process optimization.

2. Key Questions to Explore

- How are tickets currently assigned, and what are the bottlenecks?
 - What criteria should determine ticket assignment (e.g., skill, priority, workload)?
 - How can automation or AI improve accuracy and speed of ticket routing?
 - What tools or platforms could best support this system (e.g., Zendesk, ServiceNow, Jira Service Management)?
 - How will success be measured — what KPIs matter most?
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3. Brainstorming Session

Conduct workshops or team brainstorming using techniques such as:

- **Mind Mapping:** Explore all possible approaches (manual, rules-based, AI-based).
- **Crazy 8s or SCAMPER:** Encourage creative, even unconventional ideas.
- **Pain Point Mapping:** Identify specific inefficiencies in the current ticket workflow.

Sample Ideas Generated:

1. **AI-driven auto-routing engine** using NLP to categorize tickets.
 2. **Skill-based assignment matrix** that dynamically updates agent capabilities.
 3. **Real-time workload monitor** that auto-balances ticket queues.
 4. **Predictive analytics dashboard** to forecast peak load times.
 5. **Self-service ticket deflection** to reduce inbound volume.
 6. **Gamified assignment system** that rewards fast and quality resolutions.
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4. Concept Evaluation & Shortlisting

Use criteria such as:

- **Feasibility:** Can it be built with current tools/resources?
- **Impact:** Will it significantly improve support metrics?
- **Cost:** What is the investment versus expected ROI?
- **Scalability:** Can it handle increased ticket volume?
- **User Experience:** How will it affect agents and customers?

Top Concepts Selected:

1. Automated skill-based routing engine
 2. Real-time workload balancing module
 3. AI-driven ticket categorization and prioritization
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5. Concept Sketching / Process Mapping

Visualize how each idea would work:

- Create **flow diagrams** for the new ticket assignment workflow.
 - Sketch user interfaces for dashboards and routing tools.
 - Map out integration points with existing systems (CRM, chatbots, etc.).
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6. Prototype Definition

Define what will be built or simulated in the next phase (Design/Prototype):

- Prototype a **ticket classification model** using historical ticket data.
 - Build a **mock dashboard** showing automated routing and workload balancing.
 - Simulate **assignment logic** using rules + AI prediction.
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7. Expected Outcomes

By the end of the ideation phase, you should have:

- A **clear problem statement** and **defined goals**.
 - A **prioritized list of solution ideas**.
 - **Preliminary process maps or sketches** of how the solution will work.
 - A **prototype plan** ready for validation in the next phase.
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8. Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
Problem Definition Document	Defines the key issues with current ticket assignment

Deliverable	Description
Ideation Workshop Notes	Summary of brainstormed ideas
Concept Evaluation Matrix	Ranking of ideas by feasibility, impact, and cost
Solution Concept Brief	Description of top 2–3 ideas selected for prototyping
Workflow Sketches	Visual maps of proposed ticket routing logic